

Customer Offboarding Process

Leave a lasting impression — even at goodbye.

Prepared By	Approved By	Review Date	Department
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1. PURPOSE

This SOP defines the process for handling customer offboarding — the closure or termination of a customer's account or relationship with [Company Name]. The goal is to ensure every offboarding is handled professionally, compliantly, and in a way that leaves the door open for the customer to return in the future.

A well-handled offboarding protects the company's reputation, ensures regulatory compliance, secures all outstanding obligations, and captures valuable feedback to improve products and services.

2. SCOPE

- All customer-facing and operations staff involved in account closure or offboarding
- All types of customer exits — voluntary closure, involuntary closure, dormancy, death and business dissolution
- Individual and business customers across all product lines

3. TYPES OF CUSTOMER OFFBOARDING

Type	Description	Triggered By
Voluntary Closure	Customer requests to close their account or end their service	Customer request
Involuntary Closure	Company closes the account due to policy violation, fraud, or non-compliance	Internal decision
Dormancy Closure	Account closed due to prolonged inactivity as per company policy	System / Operations

Deceased Customer	Account closure following the death of the account holder	Next of kin / Legal
Business Dissolution	Business account closure following company winding up or insolvency	Legal / Regulatory
Regulatory Closure	Account closed following a regulatory directive or court order	Regulator / Court

4. ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

Role	Responsibility
CX Agent	Receives and logs offboarding request, attempts retention where appropriate, guides customer through closure process
Operations Lead	Reviews and approves offboarding requests, oversees involuntary closures, ensures SLA compliance
Compliance Officer	Reviews closures with regulatory implications, approves deceased and regulatory closures
Finance Team	Processes final settlements, refunds, and balance clearances
IT / Systems	Deactivates accounts, revokes access, archives customer data as per data retention policy

5. RETENTION ATTEMPT BEFORE OFFBOARDING

Before processing any voluntary offboarding request, the CX Agent must make a genuine attempt to retain the customer. This is not about pressuring the customer — it is about understanding their concern and offering a solution where one exists.

Reason for Leaving	Suggested Retention Response
Too expensive	Offer a discounted plan, loyalty pricing, or a fee waiver for a defined period. Escalate to Team Leader for approval if needed.
Poor service experience	Acknowledge and apologize sincerely. Offer to escalate the issue for immediate resolution. Propose a service credit or goodwill gesture.
Switching to a competitor	Highlight the unique value of your product or service. Offer a comparison and address any specific concerns the customer raises.
No longer needs the service	Offer to pause or suspend the account instead of closing it. Explain that reopening may take longer than a suspension.

Relocation	Check if the service is available in the customer's new location. Offer to transfer the account where possible.
Financial difficulty	Offer a payment plan, reduced plan, or temporary suspension. Escalate for approval if needed.

NOTE: If the customer declines all retention offers, respect their decision and proceed with offboarding professionally. Never pressure or guilt a customer into staying.

6. OFFBOARDING PROCESS

◆ Step 1 — Receive & Verify the Request

1. Receive the offboarding request via any channel — phone, email, walk-in, or app
2. Verify the customer's identity using at least 2 security questions
3. Confirm the account details and type of closure being requested
4. Log the request in the CRM immediately with date, time, and channel
5. Assign a unique offboarding reference number and share it with the customer

◆ Step 2 — Attempt Retention

6. Ask the customer for their reason for leaving — listen without interrupting
7. Acknowledge their concern empathetically
8. Offer appropriate retention solutions as per Section 5
9. If the customer accepts — resolve the underlying issue and update CRM accordingly
10. If the customer declines — proceed to Step 3

◆ Step 3 — Check for Outstanding Obligations

11. Check for any outstanding balances or unpaid amounts on the account
12. Check for any active loans, subscriptions, or commitments tied to the account
13. Check for any pending transactions or disputes
14. Inform the customer of any outstanding obligations and agree on a settlement plan
15. Do not proceed with closure until all outstanding obligations are resolved

◆ Step 4 — Process the Closure

16. Submit the closure request for approval as per the authorization matrix
17. Finance team processes any refunds of credit balances within the SLA
18. IT team deactivates the account and revokes all system access
19. Notify all relevant internal teams of the closure
20. Archive all customer data as per the data retention policy

◆ Step 5 — Communicate & Close

21. Send the customer a written closure confirmation via their preferred channel
22. Include the effective date of closure and reference number in the communication
23. Inform the customer of how their data will be handled post-closure
24. Send an exit survey to capture feedback — this is mandatory for all voluntary closures
25. Close the offboarding ticket in the CRM and mark as complete

7. AUTHORIZATION MATRIX

Closure Type	Approval Required From	Turnaround Time
Voluntary — Standard	CX Team Leader	Same business day
Voluntary — High Value Customer	Operations Lead + CX Manager	24 hours
Involuntary — Policy Violation	Operations Lead + Compliance	24 hours
Involuntary — Fraud	Compliance Officer + Management	Immediate
Deceased Customer	Compliance Officer	5 business days
Regulatory Closure	Compliance Officer + Legal	As directed by regulator

8. SERVICE LEVEL AGREEMENTS

Task	SLA	Owner
Acknowledge offboarding request	Same day	CX Agent
Complete retention attempt	Within 24 hours of request	CX Agent
Resolve outstanding obligations	3 business days	Finance / CX
Process account closure	3-5 business days	Operations / IT
Process refund of credit balance	5 business days	Finance
Send closure confirmation	Same day as closure	CX Agent
Archive customer data	Within 7 days of closure	IT / Compliance

9. DECEASED CUSTOMER PROCESS

Handling the account of a deceased customer requires extra sensitivity, care, and compliance. The following process applies:

- Accept notification of death from a next of kin, legal representative, or official authority
- Request a copy of the death certificate and proof of the claimant's identity and relationship to the deceased
- Immediately restrict the account to prevent unauthorized transactions
- Do not close the account until legal authority has been established (Letters of Administration or Grant of Probate)
- Refer the matter to the Compliance Officer for review and approval
- Process the final settlement to the estate as directed by the legal representative
- Maintain the highest level of sensitivity and empathy throughout all interactions with the family

NOTE: Never discuss account balances or details with an unauthorized person, even a family member, without proper legal documentation.

10. DATA HANDLING POST-CLOSURE

- All customer data must be retained for a minimum of 7 years post-closure for regulatory and audit purposes
- Active account access must be revoked immediately upon closure
- Customer data must be stored securely in line with the Data Protection Act, 2019
- Customers must be informed of how their data will be used and stored after closure
- Data destruction at the end of the retention period must be documented and authorized
- Any data breach during the offboarding process must be reported to the Data Protection Officer immediately

11. EXIT SURVEY

An exit survey must be sent to all voluntarily offboarded customers within 24 hours of closure confirmation. The survey should capture:

Survey Question	Purpose
What was your primary reason for leaving?	Identify root causes of churn
How satisfied were you with our service overall?	Measure overall satisfaction
Was your offboarding handled professionally?	Assess offboarding quality

Would you recommend us to others?	Net Promoter Score (NPS)
Would you consider returning in the future?	Assess win-back potential
Any additional comments or suggestions?	Open feedback for improvement

NOTE: Exit survey results must be compiled and shared with the CX Manager monthly. Recurring themes must be escalated to the relevant department for action.

12. REPORTING

Frequency	Report	Audience
Weekly	Number of offboardings by type, SLA adherence, retention rate	Operations Lead & CX Manager
Monthly	Churn rate, exit survey results, revenue impact, trends	Senior Management
Quarterly	Strategic analysis of churn drivers and retention effectiveness	Executive Leadership

13. DOCUMENT CONTROL

Version	Date	Author	Changes
1.0	May 2026	Milkah Muchunu	Initial version